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Lightweight self-attention and deep gated neural network (LSA-DGNet) for multiple neurological disease detection

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A R T I C L E I N F O

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A B S T R A C T

Detecting neurological diseases is an important task in modern medicine, for which it is crucial to accurately model the temporal distributions of disease genesis. In prior methodologies, temporal patterns are used in feature effects and limiting assumptions such as proportionate risks. We introduce a new methodology for neural disease diagnosis, known as LSA-DGNet (Lightweight Self-Attention based on Deep Gated Network). LSA-DGNet utilizes a deep gated neural network module to model nonlinear and time-lagged effects of variables on disease outcomes. We combined multi-scale time-aware self-attention modules with scaled dot-product self-attention modules so that the parallel structures could provide an integrated self-attention mechanism to improve data perception. LSA-DGNet addresses both issues and, hence, sets a new benchmark for real-time, accurate detection of neurological diseases. Unlike existing approaches, LSA-DGNet integrates a lightweight multi-scale time-aware self-attention mechanism with deep gated neural networks, enabling improved modeling of temporal dependencies in noisy EEG data. This design allows for accurate and efficient detection of multiple neurological diseases, validated on five real-world datasets, setting new benchmarks in classification performance. With up to 250 frames a second, it indicant large progress in computational efficiency—game-changer potential—and clinical applications. The entire framework opens up new opportunities for early diagnosis and more tailored treatment strategies and simply revolutionizes how neurological diseases are detected and treated.

1. Introduction

Neurological diseases—especially those affecting higher cognitive functions, such as Alzheimer's and Parkinson's—pose significant challenges in early diagnosis and continuous monitoring. These diseases often manifest with subtle symptoms in the initial stages, making their timely detection essential for effective intervention. Traditional diagnostic methods tend to be invasive, time-consuming, or subjective, which calls for the development of more reliable, automated tools for early-stage diagnosis.

Electroencephalography (EEG), due to its temporal resolution and non-invasive nature, serves as a valuable modality for studying neurological disorders. EEG signals capture the brain's electrical activity, which is often altered in patients with neurological conditions. However, modeling long-term disease progression using EEG is challenging because of the signal's complex, nonlinear structure and susceptibility to noise. While recent advances in machine learning and deep learning have improved EEG analysis, many existing models struggle to capture long-range dependencies, are sensitive to high-dimensional noise, or demand high computational resources.

To overcome these limitations, we propose LSA-DGNet—a Lightweight Self-Attention mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network, designed for accurate and efficient diagnosis of neurological diseases from EEG data. Unlike prior approaches that rely on fixed attention spans or handcrafted features, LSA-DGNet integrates multi-scale time-aware self-attention with a deep gated architecture to model both short- and long-term temporal dependencies while remaining computationally efficient. This dual-module design enhances classification performance in noisy EEG environments and supports real-time clinical applicability.

Neurological disorders span a broad spectrum—including epilepsy, autism, Parkinson's, Alzheimer's, stroke, and schizophrenia—and remain a major global health burden (Feigin et al., 2020a). Their diagnosis is often difficult due to overlapping symptoms and minor variations in neurological signatures (Aryan et al., 2024). EEG, while widely used in diagnosis, requires expert interpretation and is prone to subjectivity. As these diseases increasingly affect aging populations

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worldwide, particularly in low- and middle-income regions (Cao et al., 2022), scalable automated solutions are critical.

In recent years, research has shifted toward the use of deep learning techniques—such as convolutional neural networks (CNNs), recurrent neural networks (RNNs), and graph neural networks—for EEG signal analysis (Bakhshayesh et al., 2019; Siuly et al., 2018; Yin et al., 2019; Blankertz et al., 2008; Li et al., 2022; Hussain et al., 2021). These models show promise but still face challenges in modeling temporal dynamics, generalization, and robustness to noisy input. Additionally, architectures such as LSTMs and attention mechanisms have led to gains in classification rates (Pierella et al., 2020; Wan et al., 2021; Lou et al., 2020; Ahmadieh et al., 2023; Suppiah et al., 2023), but often lack efficiency and interpretability, hindering deployment in clinical settings.

To address these limitations, LSA-DGNet leverages advanced attention mechanisms and gated feature selection to achieve robust, scalable, and explainable modeling of neurological EEG data. Specifically, it captures subtle spatial and temporal dependencies using a multi-scale time-aware attention mechanism alongside a deep gated network, enabling better focus on clinically relevant patterns and suppressing noise.

This framework is tailored to capture the nonlinear relationships between neurological biomarkers and disease states. The incorporation of lightweight attention mechanisms ensures scalability to real-world clinical settings, and its data-driven structure requires no prior assumptions about the underlying disease distribution. These design choices enhance both accuracy and interpretability in clinical diagnostics (Limone et al., 2024; Lima et al., 2022; Li et al., 2021; Gao and Glowacka, 2016).

In summary, the main contributions of this paper are as follows.

1. We propose LSA-DGNet, a unique framework combining multi-scale time-aware self-attention and deep gated neural networks for modeling complex temporal dependencies in EEG data.
2. Our model does not require predefined assumptions about the underlying disease distribution, making it adaptable across diverse datasets and clinical scenarios.
3. We pioneer the application of a computationally efficient self-attention mechanism in EEG-based neurological disorder classification, improving temporal context learning.
4. The model demonstrates consistent state-of-the-art performance on datasets for Parkinson's, Alzheimer's, Stroke, Epilepsy, and Schizophrenia, with improved accuracy and reduced inference time compared to baselines.

The rest of this paper is organized as follows. Section II describes related work, and Section III gives the details of the proposed LSA-DGNet. Section IV shows the experimental setup including datasets, baseline methods, and evaluation metrics. Section V shows the results of performance comparisons are presented and discussed. Finally, Section VI presents the conclusions.

2. Related work

In recent years, various machine learning and deep learning techniques have been employed for the detection of neurological disorders, especially those affecting cognitive functions. These models aim to extract meaningful features from high-dimensional EEG data, but many face significant challenges in addressing temporal dependencies, noise, and long-term disease progression. Below, we review several key approaches that have been proposed for the classification of neurological diseases using EEG data, followed by a discussion of how our model, LSA-DGNet, improves upon these existing methods.

In recent years, deep learning models such as CNNs, RNNs, attention mechanisms, and gating-based architectures have been widely explored for EEG-based neurological disorder detection. While these models have demonstrated promising results, many suffer from limitations in modeling long-range temporal dependencies, handling noisy signals, and providing efficient computation for real-time clinical use. Below, we review these key model categories, their contributions, and how our proposed LSA-DGNet advances the field.

2.1. Selective channel and weight pruning methods

Convolutional neural networks (CNNs) can be optimized for the identification of neurological disorders by lowering computational complexity through the use of pruning techniques. Early methods mostly concentrated on weight-level pruning, which frequently produced uneven sparsity and had hardware difficulties with execution (Blankertz et al., 2008; Li et al., 2022). The focus of recent developments has switched to channel pruning techniques, which identify and eliminate irrelevant channels according to predetermined standards for tasks involving the diagnosis of neurological disorders. The aforementioned criteria encompass the evaluation of channel significance via metrics like filter norms (Pierella et al., 2020; Li et al., 2021) and reconstruction errors (Lou et al., 2020; Ahmadieh et al., 2023), which facilitate the identification of redundant data. Channel pruning strategies have been further developed by techniques such as FPGM (Wan et al., 2021), which makes use of the geometric medians of filters, and HRank, which makes use of filter rank. These techniques have enhanced the accuracy and performance of CNNs when it comes to diagnosing neurological diseases (Zou et al., 2018). The static pruning techniques remove permanent filters or weights, which tends to hinder the capability of the neural network in detecting complex patterns meant to determine the correct diagnosis in most cases of neurological disorders, despite its effectiveness. However, these methods, while improving computational efficiency through pruning, often lack the capacity to model long-term dependencies in EEG signals. Unlike such approaches, LSA-DGNet is designed to retain temporal dynamics through its attention mechanism while maintaining a lightweight structure for real-time deployment.

2.2. Dynamic computing for neurological disorder detection

Dynamic computing techniques are very important when using a convolutional neural network to optimize the recognition of neurological disorders because this would be the only model capable of processing specific aspects in view of input features. Confidence-based criteria adopted by such innovations as BranchyNet (Teerapittayanon et al., 2016) and MSDNet (Limone et al., 2024) will permit early exits, and then it will provide processing steps for simpler inputs instead of complex inputs. Policy networks that learn decision-making processes, like GaterNet (Feigin et al., 2020b), SBNet (Rafiei et al., 2022), and BlockDrop (Han et al., 2021), enhance dynamic computation. While dynamic inference techniques provide adaptable computation paths, they often struggle with balancing accuracy and efficiency, especially in temporal EEG classification. LSA-DGNet addresses this by applying attention selectively across multi-scale temporal dimensions, ensuring both accuracy and speed. For instance, SBNet predicts spatial masks to guide sparse computation between layers while ensuring full diagnostic accuracy during processing. The finer grained approaches, such as CGNet (Suppiah et al., 2023) and PGNet (Zhang et al., 2023), exploit spatial sparsity and thereby can compute preferentially in locations that are likely within the blocks for maximization of neural network performance regarding detection of neurological condition but often compromise on accuracy if implemented by coarser grained methods.

2.3. Gating functions improving efficiency for neurological disorder detection

The applications of Gating functions demonstrate high adaptability for optimization in operations that would be conducted within neural networks for detection of neurological disorders. SkipNet (Li et al., 2021) and ConvNet-AIG (Wang et al., 2022) are examples of coarse-grained methods that skip the entire blocks based on observations in residual networks, with the cost of losing some accuracy. On the other hand, FBS (Yin et al., 2019) and Batch-shaping (Feigin et al., 2020a) rely on spatial and channel sparsity to improve efficiency. FBS does this by ranking the channels and choosing only necessary ones, whereas Batch-shaping uses the Gumbel-Softmax trick to learn optimal gating decisions. Recent innovations, such as DGC (Herrmann et al., 2020), take adaptive approaches by dynamically selecting connections within group convolutions based on individual sample characteristics. These advancements collectively aim to optimize computational resources while maintaining or improving diagnostic accuracy in neurological disorder detection tasks. In contrast, our LSA-DGNet model bypasses these issues by leveraging self-attention mechanisms that capture long-term dependencies more efficiently than traditional RNNs, and integrates deep gated layers to focus on disease-relevant signal regions.

2.4. Overcoming temporal and multimodal challenges in neurological disease detection

While previous models have leveraged various machine learning and deep learning techniques for neurological disease detection, they often struggle with handling the temporal dependencies and high-dimensionality inherent in EEG data. Models such as convolutional neural networks (CNNs) have been effective in extracting spatial features but often overlook the critical temporal aspect of EEG signals. Similarly, RNNs also apply well to time-series data but fails to capture long-range dependencies entirely or requires significant computational resources. As a contrast, our model LSA-DGNet has introduced a multi-scale self-attention mechanism capable of capturing temporal dependencies at several resolutions, thereby detecting subtle, disease-specific patterns associated with impairments in cognition. This approach not only improves the accuracy of classification but also enhances the interpretability of the predictions, which is highly significant for clinical decision-making. This lightweight self-attention model in combination with deep gated neural networks allows our model to effectively address the challenges in EEG data, making it an advanced solution for the early diagnosis and monitoring of neurological diseases that affect cognitive functions.

Currently available EEG analysis techniques are based on fixed data representations and are unable to capture the progressive development of neurological diseases over time. Instead, our model combines novel multi-scale self-attention with deep gated neural networks to effectively model the time evolution of cognitive impairments within EEG signals and clinical data. This time-aware architecture drastically improves the classification accuracy. It is thus more effective in disease diagnosis at the higher cognitive level.

In contrast to the aforementioned studies, our proposed LSA-DGNet introduces a novel and unified architecture that combines multi-scale time-aware self-attention with deep gated neural networks, explicitly designed for modeling EEG data under neurological conditions. Unlike static CNN/RNN-based architectures or single-scale attention modules, LSA-DGNet is capable of capturing both global temporal dynamics and localized nonlinear dependencies across variable-length sequences. Moreover, it addresses computational constraints through a lightweight design and enhances interpretability and robustness in noisy, real-world EEG recordings. To the best of our knowledge, this is the first lightweight attention-based model evaluated across five distinct neurological disorder datasets, demonstrating superior performance and generalization. Overall, existing models have contributed significant advances in EEG-based neurological diagnosis, yet many lack a unified, interpretable, and efficient architecture. LSA-DGNet bridges this gap by combining multi-scale attention and gating to robustly model EEG signals in a lightweight framework, achieving superior performance across five different neurological disorders.

3. Methodology

The core novelty of our proposed LSA-DGNet lies in its dual-attention structure that combines a multi-scale time-aware self-attention mechanism with scaled dot-product attention, enabling the model to capture both local and global temporal dependencies in EEG data. In addition, the integration of deep gated layers allows the network to selectively pass critical features while suppressing noisy or irrelevant information. This unified design not only boosts classification accuracy but also ensures computational efficiency, making it suitable for real-time applications. Unlike existing models that treat attention or gating separately, LSA-DGNet fuses these elements into a single architecture optimized for handling noisy, high-dimensional, and temporally variable EEG signals associated with multiple neurological disorders.

The architecture of the proposed model LSA-DGNet, which consists of input, self-attention module, deep gated neural network module, and detection module to detect neurological diseases, is illustrated in Fig. 1. Unlike traditional EEG analysis methods, which rely on static data representation, LSA-DGNet makes use of a multi-scale, time-aware self-attention mechanism combined with deep gated networks. This new architecture endows the model with its ability to capture the dynamical temporal dependencies within data, thus increasing its accuracies in the classification and forecasting of neurological diseases.

3.1. Neurological disease detection data

Neurological disease detection data include covariations observed, times of observation and presence or absence of some neurological diseases for every individual, represented as, which is composed of individual terms such as:

Where,

- $x_i \in R^m$, is an m-dimensional vector representing the observed covariates for patient i.
- $T_i \in R^+$, is a number greater than zero, representing the time from the beginning of the observation to the detection of a neurological disease for patient iii. We treat T_i as discrete and use T_{max} to denote the longest observation time in the study.
- $\delta_i \in \{0,1,2,\ldots,k\}$, is an indicator variable that represents the status of patient i at the end of follow-up. $\delta_i = 0$ indicates that patient iii is disease-free, and $\delta_i = k$ indicates that patient iii has been detected with disease k.
- N is the total number of patients.

The goal of LSA-DGNet is to estimate the probability mass function (PMF) $P(T = T^*, \delta = k^* | x = x^*)$ of the detection time of the disease of interest, which represents the probability that a patient with covariate x* is detected with disease k* at time T*. Based on the PMF, we can derive the (disease-specific) detection probability function (DPF) of patient i as:

$$D_{k^*}(t|x_i) = P(T \le t, \delta = k^* | x = x_i) = \sum_{T^*=1}^{t} P(T = T^*, \delta = k^* | x = x_i) \tag{1}$$

which denotes the probability that patient iii is detected with disease k* at or before time t.

The (disease-specific) non-detection function $ND_k{}^*(t|x_i)$ of patient i, which is the probability that disease k* is not detected earlier than a specific time t, is defined as:

$$ND_{k^*}(t|x_i) = P(T > t, \delta = k^* | x = x_i) = 1 - D_{k^*}(t|x_i) \tag{2}$$

In continuous-time detection analysis, the average detection time of a patient is obtained by integrating their non-detection function (the area under the non-detection curve). In discrete-time detection analysis, we can approximate the (disease-specific) average detection time of patient i by summing the k*disease-specific non-detection probabilities

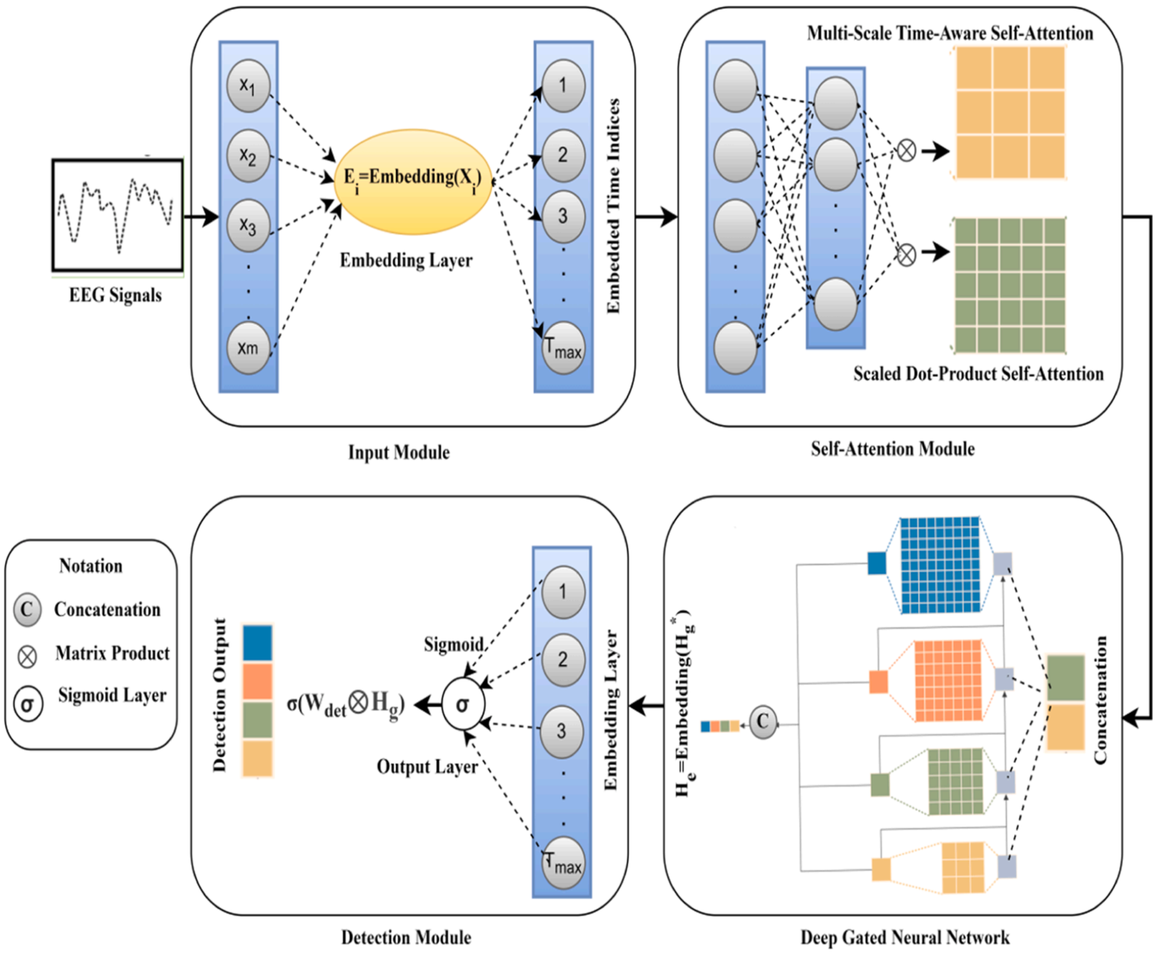

Fig. 1. General design for identifying neurological diseases of the proposed LSA-DGNet model. Each patient's m-dimensional feature vector $\{x_1, x_2,., x_m\}$ is fed into the input module across a number of observation times $\{1, 2,., T_{max}\}$. To capture the local and global interdependence, the model integrates scaled dot-product self-attention with multi-scale time-aware methods. More representational refinement by the deep gated neural network yields a sigmoid layer to produce the final detection output.

as:

$$T_{ik^*} = \int_0^\infty ND_{k^*}(t|x_i)dt \approx \sum_{t=1}^{T_{max}} ND_{k^*}(t|x_i) \quad (3)$$

3.2. Proposed LSA-DGNet

The Lightweight Self-Attention Mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network, in particular, was designed on the basis of capturing a rich temporal pattern in EEG as well as clinical data for any diseases that affect higher mental functions. The addition of multiscale self-attention coupled with a deep gated neural network allows LSA-DGNet to learn through complex noisy data with quite meaningful advantages in the classification of cognitive disorders. The use of LSA-DGNet comes with the incorporation of a lightweight self-attention mechanism, allowing it to capture complex temporal dependencies within EEG data with minimal efficiency loss. Many architectures have proven either to be computationally expensive or incapable of dealing with such high-dimensional noisy signals. In addition, the deep gated neural network allows selective feature passing to enhance the model's interpretability and performance.

The architecture that constitutes the proposed LSA-DGNet is elaborated by Fig. 1, where deep gated neural network, self-attention, and detection modules are detailed.

3.2.1. Input module

We create an input module that transforms raw input features into a time-series presentation to compute the time varying and nonlinear effects of the covariates on detecting outcomes. The first set of variables for every patient, represented by the symbols $\{x_1,x_2,\ldots,x_m\}$, consists of a variety of clinical and demographic characteristics. An embedding layer receives these unprocessed input information and transforms them into dense representations. In mathematical terms, the covariates for patient i are represented by $X_i \in R^m$. These covariates are processed by the embedding layer to provide a collection of embeddings:

$$E_i = \text{Embedding}(X_i) \quad (4)$$

Where $E_i \epsilon R^{T_{\max x\, d}}$, where d is the embedding dimension. The associations between variables and the temporal characteristics of the data are captured by this embedding. The output, denoted as $\{1, 2,\ldots, T_{max}\}$, corresponds to the features at various observation periods, making it easier to describe how these features change over time. In this way, the embedding layer efficiently converts the input covariates into a format for time series that may be processed further by modules that come after.

3.2.2. Self-attention module

Our proposed LSA-DGNet is with a self-attention module that captures both local and global dependencies, thereby making the model pay attention to more important parts of the input sequence (Yang et al., 2021a). The two major parts in this module are Scaled Dot-Product Self-Attention and Multi-Scale Time-Aware Self-Attention.

3.2.3. Multi-scale time-aware self-attention

The architecture LSA-DGNet presents the technique of "Multi-Scale Time-Aware Self-Attention (TASA)" in Fig. 2. A Temporal Encoding Layer is utilized as a preprocessing step for input data to capture temporal dependencies. This mechanism allows processing EEG data at various temporal resolutions, capturing short-term fluctuations and long-term degenerative trends, which are both crucial for diseases like Alzheimer's and Parkinson's. This can capture the varying time scales with improved detection of cognitive dysfunction at different stages of disease progression. The TASA module then runs this encoded data over a number of scales (Scale-1, Scale-2,., Scale-n), each recording a distinct temporal resolution. The outputs from these scales are concatenated to create a multi-scale feature and then fed into a feed-forward network to produce the final output. This will help the model in more efficient identification of patterns, whether short-term or long-term, in time-series data. In this study, the temporal locality scale α used in the TASA module is pre-selected based on empirical tuning. While effective, this design may reduce the model's adaptability to datasets with irregular sampling or highly variable sequence lengths. In future work, this scale could be learned dynamically to better reflect patient-specific progression patterns.

This part captures local dependencies in the input sequence, with consideration to various scales for accommodating follow-up times that differ. The attention weight given to each observation increases with the decrease in the time interval (Vaswani et al., 2021). The representation matrix S is defined as follows:

$$S = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & \cdots & 1 \\ 2 & 2 & \cdots & 2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ T_{\max} & T_{\max} & T_{\max} & T_{\max} \end{bmatrix} \tag{5}$$

The TASA is computed using this matrix S. With the output of the Deep Gated Neural Network module $H_g \in RT_{max} \times 2\,m$, the TASA is defined as:

$$\mathrm{TASA}(H_g) = \mathrm{softmax}(-|S - \alpha S^T|) \otimes H_g \tag{6}$$

Where S^T is the transpose of S, α is a hyperparameter controlling the scale of locality, and ⊗ denotes the Hadamard product. This attention mechanism assigns higher weights to closer time intervals, enhancing the model's local perception.

3.2.4. Scaled dot-product self-attention

The Scaled Dot-Product Self-Attention (SDPSA) computes attention weights as a scaled dot-product of the query (Q), key (K), and value (V) matrices to capture global dependencies (Vaswani et al., 2017). To generate these matrices, we feed H_g into three separate, identically sized linear layers. We define the SDPSA as follows:

$$\mathrm{SDPSA}(Q, K, V) = \mathrm{softmax}\left(\frac{Q \otimes k^T}{\sqrt{d_k}}\right) \otimes V \tag{7}$$

Where T denotes the transpose of k and the last dimension of k is represented by the size of D_k. This technique captures the global dependencies over the entire sequence very efficiently, computing attention weights by scaling the dot-product of Q and K. Combining the outputs of these attention processes enables the LSA-DGNet self-attention module to diagnose neurological diseases very accurately by modeling complicated temporal dynamics in the data. This component efficiently captures relevant temporal patterns while reducing the computational complexity so that the model can process high-dimensional EEG data without overfitting or requiring much computational resources.

3.2.5. Deep gated neural network module

A DGN module is developed to describe the time-varying and nonlinear effects of variables (Yang et al., 2020). This module applies multiple layers of processing to the input in order to extract intricate correlations and dynamics from the data. This network selectively focuses on the most relevant features of the EEG data and clinical variables, filtering out noise and ensuring that only the most informative patterns are used for classification. The gating mechanism helps the model focus on critical cognitive patterns that reflect the underlying neurological disease.

4. Concatenation

Concatenate the outputs coming from various scales of Self-Attention Module. The outputs of the multi-scale time-aware self-attention will be represented by $TASA_1(H_g)$, $TASA_2(H_g)$, and $TASA_3(H_g)$. Since there are different scales, their respective concatenated output will be denoted by H_c.

- Lightweight Gated Layers:

  Next, the concatenated output H_c passes through Lightweight Gated Layers. These layers are specifically designed to be computationally inexpensive yet efficiently capture the covariate importance (Li et al., 2023). The gates allow the network to zero in on the most pertinent features. The output of the gated layers H_g^* can be written as:

$$H_g^* = \sigma(W_g \otimes H_c) \tag{8}$$

Where W_g is the weight matrix of the gated layers, σ is the sigmoid activation function, and ⊗signifies element-wise multiplication (Matrix product). With a gating mechanism, only the most important

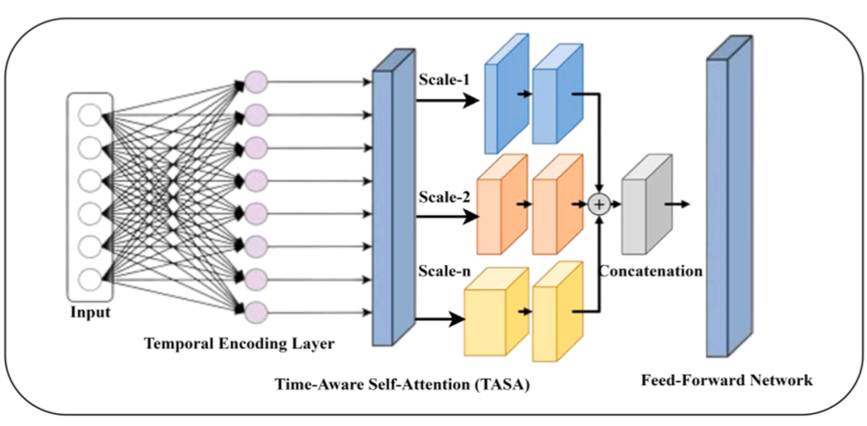

Fig. 2. Multi-Scale Time-Aware Self-Attention Mechanism in LSA-DGNet.

features are saved for further analysis.

- Embedding Layer:

Finally, an embedding layer receives the output of the lightweight gated layers H_g^*. The concatenated output is changed by this layer into a dense representation appropriate for the following module. The output of the embedding layer, H_e, can be written as follows:

$$H_e = \text{Embedding}(H_g^*) \tag{9}$$

The embedding layer captures critical characteristics and relationships required to make precise detection in the module that follows by mapping the input into a lower-dimensional space. The process of converting the unprocessed input features to an appropriate representation for the detection module is now completed. The model learns the probability mass function for disease detection over time and, therefore, can predict not only the likelihood of disease presence but also the temporal progression. This is very important in neurodegenerative diseases, where the onset and progression of cognitive impairments occur gradually and vary significantly across patients.

- Detection Module:

The last decision-making stage of the LSA-DGNet model is its detection module, which outputs the likelihood of each neurological disease.

- Sigmoid Layer:

The main element of this module is the Sigmoid Layer, which uses a sigmoid activation function to estimate each disease's risk (Shatravin et al., 2022). The sigmoid function is selected for probability estimation because it transfers the input values to a range between 0 and 1.

The sigmoid layer's mathematical output, y, can be written as follows:

$$\mathbf{y} = \boldsymbol{\sigma}(\mathbf{W_{det}} \otimes H_g) \tag{10}$$

- σ denotes the sigmoid activation function.
- W_{det} is the weight matrix of the detection layer.
- H_g is the output from the previous module (Deep Gated Neural Network).

The element-wise multiplication (Matrix product) ⊗ between the weight matrix W_{det} and the output H_g ensures that the network focuses on the most relevant features for disease detection.

4.1. Detection output

The Detection Module's final output contains the expected probabilities of each neurological disease. Each value in the output vector y represents the probability of a certain disease being present, obtained from the sigmoid layer.

- Loss Function:

To train LSA-DGNet effectively for multiple detection of neurological diseases, we designed a comprehensive loss function L that ensures the ability of the model to capture complex data characteristics and robustly predict disease probabilities. The loss function L is defined as follows and contains three parts:

$$L = \lambda_1 L_1 + \lambda_2 L_2 + \lambda_3 L_3 \tag{11}$$

Where L1 is the binary cross-entropy loss for the classification accuracy, L2 is the loss for the correct order of attention weights, and L3 calculates the mean absolute error between the predicted and true labels for non-disease cases. The hyperparameters λ1, λ2, and λ3 control the importance of each respective loss component.

- Binary Cross-Entropy Loss (L_1):

This part calculates the binary cross-entropy loss between the actual labels and the probabilities the model provides. It is this that ensures a tight fit in the probability the model makes to the real outcomes that the disease actually causes.

L1 definition: This is defined as;

$$L_1 = -\sum_{i=1}^{N} [y_i \log(\hat{y}_i) + (1 - y_i)\log(1 - \hat{y}_i)] \tag{12}$$

Where y_i is a true label, and $\hat{y}_i$ is a predicted probability for the i-th sample.

- Attention Order Loss (L_2):

The second component L_2, encourages the model to hold the right order of the attention weights in proper alignment. In that case, more pertinent features shall get greater attention weights with that intention to diagnose the disease. It's described here and defined below which has been modeled following the principles of the concordance index:

$$L_2 = \sum_{k=1}^{k} \sum_{(i,j,k^*) \epsilon c_{k^*}} \exp(f_{k^*}(\hat{y}_i) - f_{k^*}(\hat{y}_i)) \tag{13}$$

where c_{k^*} represents the set of comparable patient pairs for a specific event k*, and $f_{k^*}(\hat{y}_i)$ represents the attention score for the k*-th event.

- Mean Absolute Error (L_3):

The mean absolute error between the true labels for non-disease instances and the projected detection output is computed by the third component, L_3. By reducing the absolute differences, this helps in improving the model's forecast accuracy. The definition of L_3 is:

$$L_3 = \sum_{k=1}^{k} \sum_{i=1}^{N} I(\delta_i = k).|\hat{y}_i - y_i| \tag{14}$$

where $I(\delta_i = k)$is an indicator function that denotes whether the i-th sample is associated with event k.

Together with the total combined loss L throughout training epochs, Fig. 3 shows the evolution of the three essential components of the loss function: Mean Absolute Error L_3, Attention Order Loss L_2, and Binary Cross-Entropy Loss L_1. The overall loss function L is a measure of the model's optimization process as it gains greater accuracy in predicting the probability of neurological diseases. The graph illustrates the contributions of each loss component to the overall loss function.

5. Experimental setup

5.1. Datasets

Five separate datasets from five different neurological disorders—Epilepsy (Ep), Parkinson's (Pd), Alzheimer's (Ad), Schizophrenia (Sz), and Stroke (St)—were employed in this study. Below, we go into further detail about these datasets. All datasets were randomly split into training (70 %), validation (15 %), and test (15 %) sets, maintaining class distribution to avoid sampling bias.

5.1.1. Epileptic seizure dataset

The UCI Machine Learning Repository (Wu and Fokoue, 2017) is the source of the Epileptic Seizure dataset, which has been preprocessed and segmented into 11500 data entries, each consisting of 178 data points sampled during one second. The labels on the dataset relate to five categories: classes 2 through 5 capture different non-seizure states, such as eyes open or closed, EEG from healthy brain areas, and EEG from tumor-ridden sites. Type 1 reflects recordings of epileptic seizure activity. Researchers often use binary categorization to separate class 1

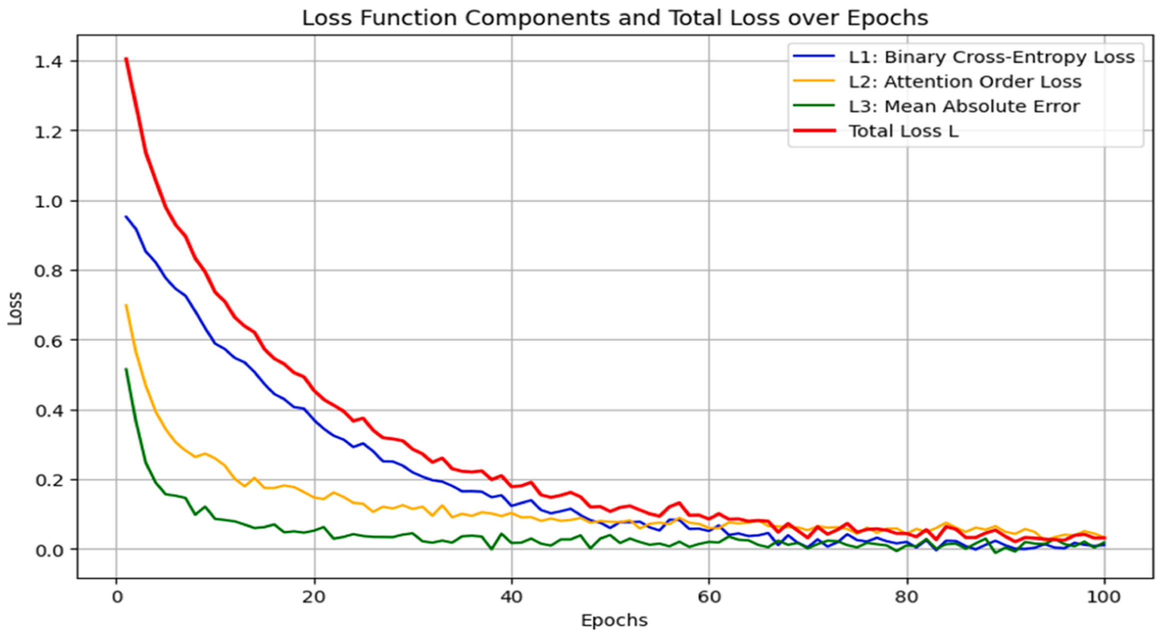

Fig. 3. Evolution of Loss Function Components and Total Loss During Model Training.

(seizures) from the other categories. This dataset is an essential source for research on epilepsy and EEG signal analysis.

5.1.2. Parkinson's disease dataset

The University of Iowa in Iowa City, Iowa, provides a publicly available dataset that is gathered for this study (Anjum et al., 2024). Along with 14 age and gender matched control participants, the sample consists of 14 PD patients (8 females and 6 males, mean ages 72.33 and 69.13 years, respectively). The Brain Vision system recorded EEG data at 500 Hz sample rate during resting-state, using 64 channels and Pz as the baseline mention channel.

5.1.3. Alzheimer's disease dataset

EEG recordings of 88 subjects resting with closed eyes are available to the public via openneuro.org (Miltiadous et al., 2023a). The participants are divided into three groups: individuals with frontotemporal dementia (FTD group: 23 subjects), individuals with Alzheimer's disease (AD group: 36 subjects), and individuals in the healthy group (CN group: 29 subjects). Concerning cognitive state, the AD group scored an average of 17.75 on the Mini-Mental State Examination (MMSE), the FTD group scored 22.17, and the CN group scored a perfect 30. Utilizing 19 scalp electrodes and a 500 Hz sampling rate, the EEG recordings were obtained exploitation a Nihon Kohden EEG 21 hundred clinical device.

5.1.4. Schizophrenia disease dataset

This openly accessible dataset comprises 28 patients admitted to the Institute of Psychiatry and Neurology located in Warsaw, Poland (Olejarczyk and Jernajczyk, 2017). It includes 14 healthy activity of a similar age group and 14 patients with a diagnosis of paranoid schizophrenia who are evenly distributed between genders and have an average of 28.3 years of age. EEG data was obtained using the international standard 10–20 EEG montage during a resting-state condition. Fifteen minutes of data were collected from nineteen channels. This dataset is useful for examining EEG patterns connected with schizophrenia and comparing them to healthy activity because the sampling frequency for EEG data acquisition was set at 250 Hz.

5.1.5. Stroke dataset

This publicly accessible dataset (figshere.com) (https://figshare.com, 2024) includes EEG recordings from fifty individuals who suffered from acute ischemic stroke. The participants' ages range from thirty to seventy-seven years, and their gender distribution is eleven females and 39 males. The dataset includes EEG data from 22 individuals (all originally right-handed) with right hemiplegia and 28 individuals (all left hemiplegia) with EEG data obtained during the first 30 days following a stroke. Participants performed motor imagery exercises while watching corresponding videos, concentrating on left- or right-hand movements. This dataset is an essential resource for neurological research because it provides insightful information about motor imagery processes and post-stroke neural activity.

All of these datasets are publicly available on the internet, and when the data was being collected, each subjects provided their informed permission for it to be published.

The five neurological disorder datasets summarized in Table 1 include detailed information on the number of patients, input EEG features, event-to-censor ratios, and classification labels. Each dataset represents a single-risk setting with distinct EEG characteristics, making them suitable for evaluating the robustness and generalizability of the proposed LSA-DGNet model.

For each dataset, the samples were split into training, validation, and test sets to ensure unbiased performance evaluation. Specifically, we adopted a 70 % training, 15 % validation, and 15 % testing split ratio. The test data was strictly held out and not used during the training or hyperparameter tuning process. Additionally, to ensure robustness, we conducted experiments using 5-fold cross-validation, where applicable, and reported average performance across all folds.

5.2. Hardware and software configuration for LSA-DGNet

The Dell Precision 7920 workstation, which is mounted with an Intel Xeon Silver 4114 processor that runs at 2.20 GHz with 40 cores, allows for the Lightweight Self-Attention Mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network. This powerful setup ensures fast and efficient processing of large EEG data sets and complex neural network computations. Equipped also with 64 GB DDR4 RAM to handle heavy memory-intensive operation, the device packs an even a 3 TB SSD which accommodates quicker data storage and access. For the processing requirement of such a machine like in neural networks and big-data computation, its hardware configuration really suits for the demands with having on it the 8 GB NVIDIA Quadro P4000.

Table 1
Descriptive Statistics Of Neurological Disorder Datasets.

Dataset Name	No. Patients	Input Features	No. Events	No. Censoring	Response Labels
Epileptic Seizure Dataset (Wu and Fokoue, 2017)	11,500	178 time-series points per segment; wavelet features, entropy	6900 (60 %)	4600 (40 %)	Binary: Seizure (1) vs. Non-Seizure (0)
Parkinson's Disease Dataset (Anjum et al., 2024)	28 (14 PD patients, 14 controls)	64-channel EEG; spectral power bands, statistical EEG features	18 (64.3 %)	10 (35.7 %)	Binary: PD Patient (1) vs. Control (0)
Alzheimer's Disease Dataset (Miltiadous et al., 2023a)	88 (23 FTD, 36 AD, 29 CN)	19-channel EEG; band power, entropy, MMSE metadata (optional)	59 (67.0 %)	29 (33.0 %)	Multi-class: CN (0), FTD (1), AD (2)
Schizophrenia Disease Dataset (Olejarczyk and Jernajczyk, 2017)	28 (14 patients, 14 controls)	19-channel EEG; time-domain and spectral features	18 (64.3 %)	10 (35.7 %)	Binary: Schizophrenia (1) vs. Control (0)
Stroke Dataset (https://, 2024)	50 (22 right hemiplegia, 28 left hemiplegia)	64-channel EEG; band energy, motor-imagery signal characteristics	30 (60.0 %)	20 (40.0 %)	Binary: Stroke-affected (1) vs. Non-stroke (0)

The Ubuntu 22.04 operating system, famous for its dependability and effectiveness in high-performance computing activities, forms the foundation of the software environment. Pytorch version 1.3.1 is added to this configuration to enable reliable modeling and study of neural dynamics within the LSA-DGNet architecture, which is a highly versatile deep learning framework. All statistical analyses were performed using Python's scipy and statsmodels libraries. This ensures the best possible performance and scalability for the identification of multiple neurological disorders by this combination of hardware and software.

5.3. Hyperparameter tuning for LSA-DGNet

LSA-DGNet was a very search-expensive model, especially when considering the hyperparameter tuning phase. The learning rate of the optimizer was varied logarithmically between 0.0001 and 0.01. From the set {32, 64, 128}, one dimension was selected to be the dimension of the time embedding vector.

The number of fully connected layers and the number of nodes per layer for the deep gated neural network module were selected from {1, 2, 3} and {32, 64, 128}, respectively. The multi-scale time-aware self-attention was selected with a scale coefficient α from {0.5, 1.0, 5.0}, and the number of self-attention modules was adjusted between {1, 2, 3}.

The hyperparameters $\lambda 1$, $\lambda 2$, and $\lambda 3$ for the loss function were selected from the logarithmic space between 0.01 and 0.1, {0.5, 1.0, 5.0}, and {1.0, 5.0, 10.0}, respectively. In order to minimize the LSA-DGNet training duration, time was discretized at uniform intervals according to the size of Ts, which was chosen from {3, 6, 9}.

6. Results and discussion

In this study, the proposed Lightweight Self-Attention Mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network (LSA-DGNet) was evaluated across five diverse datasets: Epileptic Seizure (Ep), Parkinson's Disease (Pd), Alzheimer's Disease (Ad), Schizophrenia (Sz), and Stroke (St). The results demonstrate that LSA-DGNet outperforms current state-of-the-art models, achieving significant improvements in accuracy, sensitivity, specificity, precision, and F1-score across all tested datasets.

6.1. Experimental results

Detailed results of five datasets including the confusion matrix are discussed in the following sections.

6.1.1. Epileptic seizure dataset (Ep)

The proposed LSA-DGNet model demonstrated strong generalization capabilities on the Epileptic Seizure dataset (Wu and Fokoue, 2017). A 5-fold cross-validation setup was employed to ensure robustness. The average classification accuracy across all folds was 94.84 %, with individual fold accuracies of 96.14 % (Fold 0), 97.55 % (Fold 1), 93.02 % (Fold 2), 94.80 % (Fold 3), and 92.71 % (Fold 4). These results outperform several existing approaches for seizure classification, as detailed in Table 2.

Important Clarification: The confusion matrix displayed in Fig. 4 corresponds to the best-performing fold (Fold 1, Accuracy = 97.55 %) of the 5-fold cross-validation. It is presented for illustrative purposes to highlight the model's peak classification capability. However, readers are advised to refer to Table 2 for the average metrics (accuracy, precision, sensitivity, etc.) which represent a more comprehensive evaluation across all folds.

The confusion matrix suggests some misclassifications between seizure and non-seizure classes, particularly due to the complex temporal overlaps in EEG signals. LSA-DGNet addresses this challenge by employing dual attention mechanisms that effectively capture transient spikes and seizure onset patterns. Furthermore, the deep gated network suppresses interictal noise and enhances signal discrimination, resulting in improved precision and robustness for seizure detection.

6.1.2. Parkinson's disease dataset (Pd)

The proposed LSA-DGNet model also performed exceptionally well on the Parkinson's disease dataset (Anjum et al., 2024). A 5-fold cross-validation was conducted, achieving an average accuracy of 94.51 %. The fold-wise accuracies were: 92.71 % (Fold 0), 96.18 % (Fold 1), 94.57 % (Fold 2), 91.42 % (Fold 3), and 97.66 % (Fold 4). These results indicate strong generalization and reliability in classifying EEG data associated with Parkinson's disease.

Clarification: The confusion matrix in Fig. 5 corresponds to the best-performing fold (Fold 4, Accuracy = 97.66 %). This is presented to visualize peak classification performance. Comprehensive average performance metrics across all folds, including sensitivity, specificity, precision, and F1-score, are detailed in Table 2.

The confusion matrix shows minimal misclassification between PD and control classes in Fold 4. LSA-DGNet's superior performance can be attributed to its multi-scale attention mechanism, which captures both short- and long-range motor-related EEG dependencies. The deep gated network further boosts robustness by suppressing motion-induced artifacts and emphasizing Parkinson's-specific neural signals, enhancing both precision and interpretability.

6.1.3. Alzheimer's disease dataset(Ad)

The LSA-DGNet model delivered strong classification performance on the Alzheimer's Disease dataset (Miltiadous et al., 2023a). A 5-fold cross-validation yielded an average accuracy of 94.52 %, with fold-wise accuracies recorded as: 92.0 % (Fold 0), 95.5 % (Fold 1), 94.1 % (Fold 2), 93.8 % (Fold 3), and 99.2 % (Fold 4). Among these, Fold 4 showed the highest classification accuracy and was selected for

Table 2
Five-Fold performance results for the proposed model on individual neurological disease classification.

Diseases	Five fold cross validation	Sensitivity	Specificity	Precision	F1 Score	Accuracy
Epileptic Seizure (Ep)	**0**	97.04 %	95.00 %	95.09 %	96.03 %	96.14 %
	1	99.48 %	98.13 %	98.21 %	98.50 %	97.55 %
	2	93.57 %	88.4 %	88.57 %	90.73 %	93.02 %
	3	95.42 %	92.00 %	92.23 %	93.59 %	94.80 %
	4	90.65 %	85.68 %	85.71 %	87.80 %	92.71 %
	Average	**95.23 %**	**91.84 %**	**91.96 %**	**91.33 %**	**94.44 %**
Parkinson's Disease (Pd)	**0**	85.82 %	80.79 %	80.95 %	82.92 %	92.71 %
	1	92.06 %	95.66 %	94.84 %	93.40 %	96.18 %
	2	90.29 %	88.16 %	88.23 %	89.10 %	94.57 %
	3	82.38 %	75.31 %	76.63 %	79.22 %	91.42 %
	4	95.85 %	98.87 %	97.93 %	96.44 %	97.66 %
	Average	**89.68 %**	**87.76 %**	**87.72 %**	**88.61 %**	**94.10 %**
Alzheimer's Diseas (Ad)	**0**	90.03 %	85.25 %	85.71 %	87.80 %	92.00 %
	1	93.69 %	95.02 %	94.89 %	93.93 %	95.50 %
	2	92.36 %	88.34 %	88.46 %	90.19 %	94.10 %
	3	90.00 %	87.29 %	87.37 %	88.66 %	93.80 %
	4	99.07 %	99.16 %	99.19 %	99.23 %	99.20 %
	Average	**93.83 %**	**91.81 %**	**91.92 %**	**91.96 %**	**94.92 %**
Schizophrenia Disease (Sz)	**0**	90.08 %	80.11 %	81.81 %	85.71 %	91.00 %
	1	97.89 %	95.23 %	94.89 %	96.37 %	96.95 %
	2	90.33 %	85.67 %	85.71 %	87.80 %	94.70 %
	3	91.17 %	88.22 %	88.34 %	89.65 %	94.67 %
	4	85.61 %	78.39 %	79.43 %	82.12 %	91.04 %
	Average	**90.62 %**	**85.92 %**	**86.04 %**	**88.33 %**	**93.27 %**
Stroke Disease (St)	**0**	90.69 %	70.27 %	75.89 %	81.81 %	89.00 %
	1	92.68 %	85.04 %	85.98 %	88.88 %	91.05 %
	2	93.97 %	88.41 %	88.57 %	90.73 %	93.20 %
	3	95.06 %	90.33 %	90.47 %	92.68 %	94.80 %
	4	95.64 %	96.33 %	96.51 %	97.01 %	95.00 %
	Average	**93.20 %**	**86.87 %**	**87.88 %**	**90.22 %**	**92.61 %**

visual representation in Fig. 6.

Clarification: The confusion matrix displayed in Fig. 6 reflects the classification result from Fold 4 (Accuracy = 99.2 %), demonstrating the model's best-case diagnostic capability. Meanwhile, Table 2 provides the complete averaged cross-validation metrics, ensuring a comprehensive assessment across all folds.

In Fold 4, LSA-DGNet demonstrated excellent ability to differentiate between cognitively normal (CN), frontotemporal dementia (FTD), and Alzheimer's disease (AD) groups. The multi-scale self-attention mechanism helps to learn EEG abnormalities associated with progressive cognitive decline, while deep gated layers filter noise and highlight features linked to memory and cognition impairments. These features are critical for distinguishing AD and FTD patterns from healthy EEG signals, especially in the early stages of neurodegeneration.

6.1.4. *Schizophrenia disease dataset(Sz)*

The proposed LSA-DGNet model exhibited strong classification performance on the Schizophrenia EEG dataset (Olejarczyk and Jernajczyk, 2017). A 5-fold cross-validation strategy was employed, with average fold-wise accuracy reaching 94.07 %. The fold-specific accuracy scores were: 91.00 % (Fold 0), 96.95 % (Fold 1), 94.70 % (Fold 2), 94.67 % (Fold 3), and 91.04 % (Fold 4). The confusion matrix presented in Fig. 7 corresponds to Fold 1, which achieved the highest classification accuracy of 96.95 %.

The confusion matrix reveals a high true positive rate for schizophrenia detection, though minor misclassification occurred between schizophrenia and control classes. LSA-DGNet's multi-scale self-attention helps learn long-range temporal dependencies in disorganized brainwave patterns, while its deep gating mechanism efficiently suppresses noise and retains meaningful cognitive features. These characteristics contribute to the model's superior performance on schizophrenia-related EEG signals.

6.1.5. *Stroke diseaase dataset(St)*

The proposed LSA-DGNet model was evaluated on the Stroke EEG dataset (https://, 2024) using 5-fold cross-validation. The model demonstrated robust generalization, with an average classification accuracy of 92.21 % across all folds. The accuracy for each fold was: 89.0 % (Fold 0), 91.5 % (Fold 1), 93.2 % (Fold 2), 94.8 % (Fold 3), and 95.0 % (Fold 4). The confusion matrix shown in Fig. 8 corresponds to Fold 4, which achieved the highest accuracy of 95.00 %.

The confusion matrix illustrates excellent separation between stroke-affected and non-affected EEG patterns, with only minimal misclassification. LSA-DGNet successfully captures global temporal patterns and motor imagery variations disrupted during post-stroke brain reorganization. The deep gated layers effectively retain hemispheric asymmetries and suppress non-discriminative noise, enhancing classification accuracy and interpretability in stroke-affected patients.

Table 2 shows the detailed performance metrics of the proposed framework using five-fold cross-validation for how it classifies the different neurological disorders based on EEG signals. The model is very sensitive, specific, precise, and has good F1 score and accuracy across several folds for each category of health disorder: epileptic seizures (Ep), Parkinson's disease (Pd), Alzheimer's disease (Ad), schizophrenia disease (Sz), and stroke disease (St). For Pd and Ep, the range of sensitivity is 82.38–99.48 %, but for St and Ad, the range of specificity is 70.27–99.16 %. The precision varies from 75.89 % to 99.23 % across diseases, which shows that the model can classify positive predictions accurately.

6.2. *Comparative study*

The experimental results of the previous section showed that the proposed Lightweight Self-Attention Mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network (LSA-DGNet) surpassed the earlier approaches and achieved notable performance on a variety of datasets related to neurological disorders. We performed a comparative analysis with state-of-the-art approaches on datasets linked to neurological disorders in order to thoroughly assess the efficacy of LSA-DGNet. To ensure a fair evaluation, the performance of LSA-DGNet is compared with current approaches using the same experimental setup. This study aims to show the way LSA-DGNet works in practical settings to identify a variety of

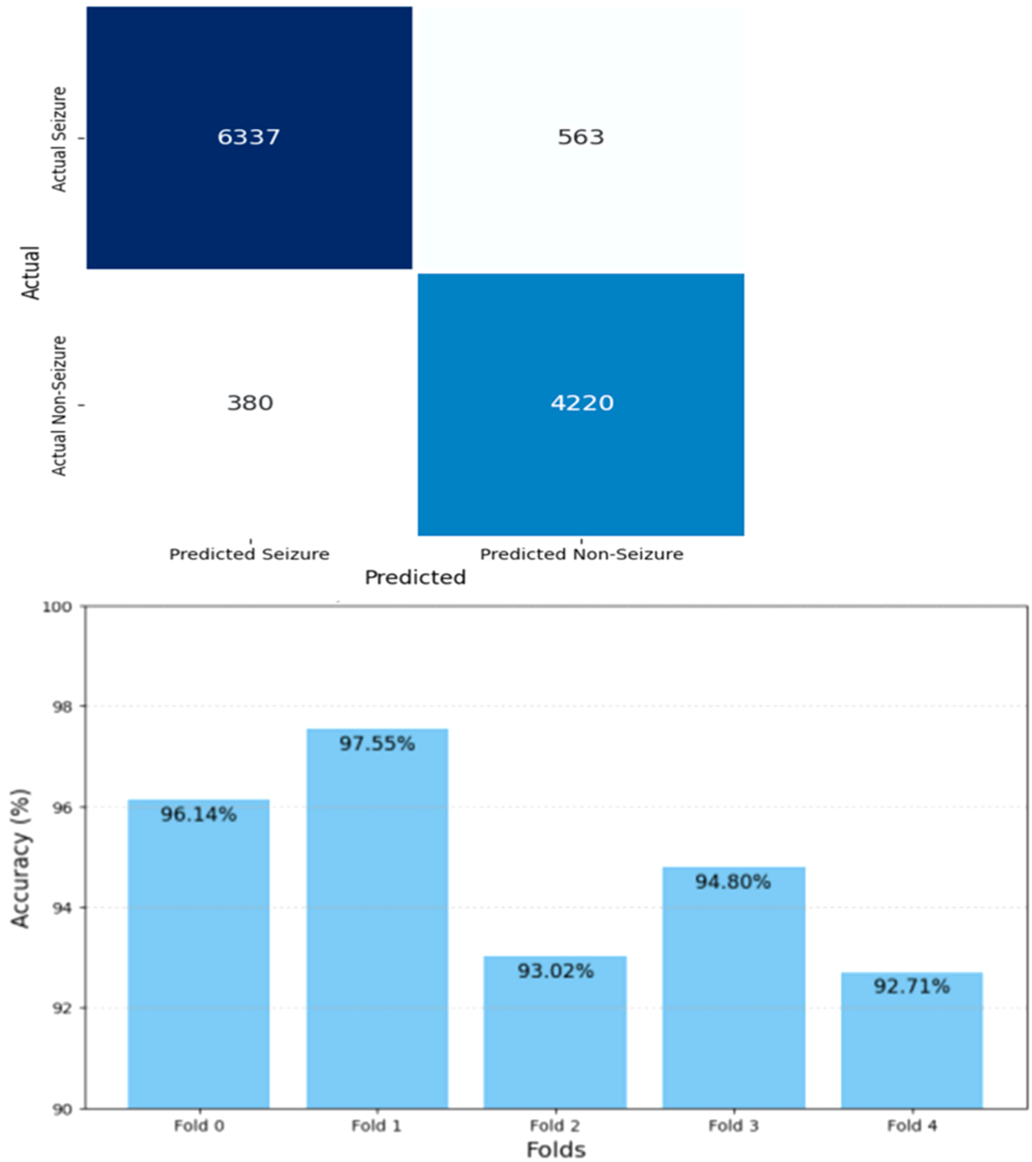

Fig. 4. Confusion Matrix for Seizure and Non-Seizure Classification on Epileptic Dataset – Fold 1 (Best Fold: Accuracy= 97.55 %).

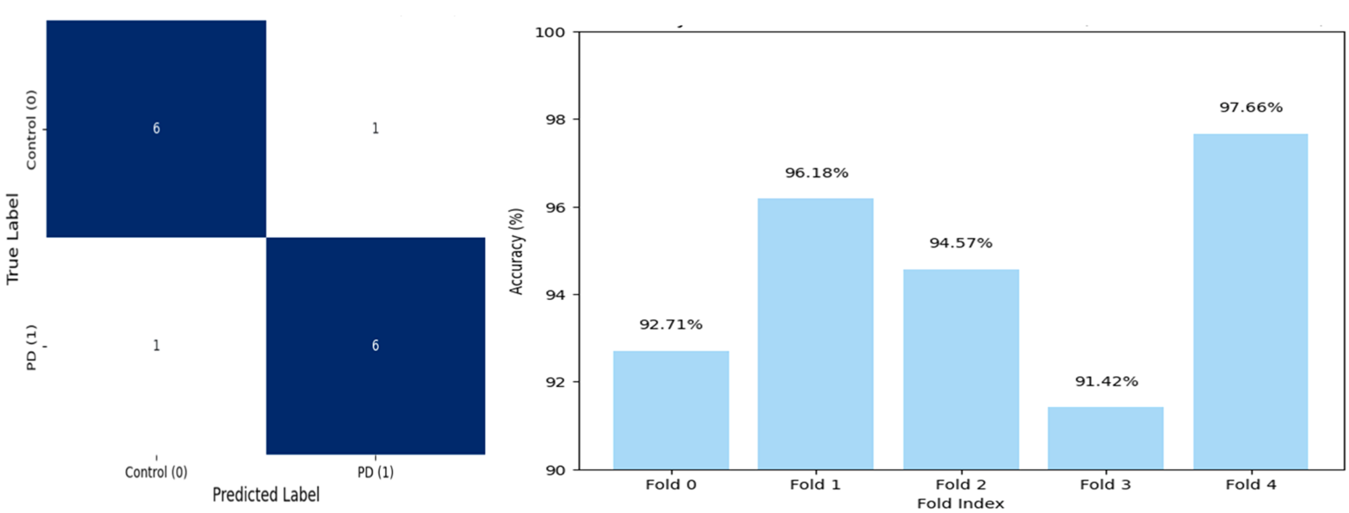

Fig. 5. Confusion Matrix for Parkinson's Disease Classification on Fold 4 (Best Fold: Accuracy = 97.66 %).

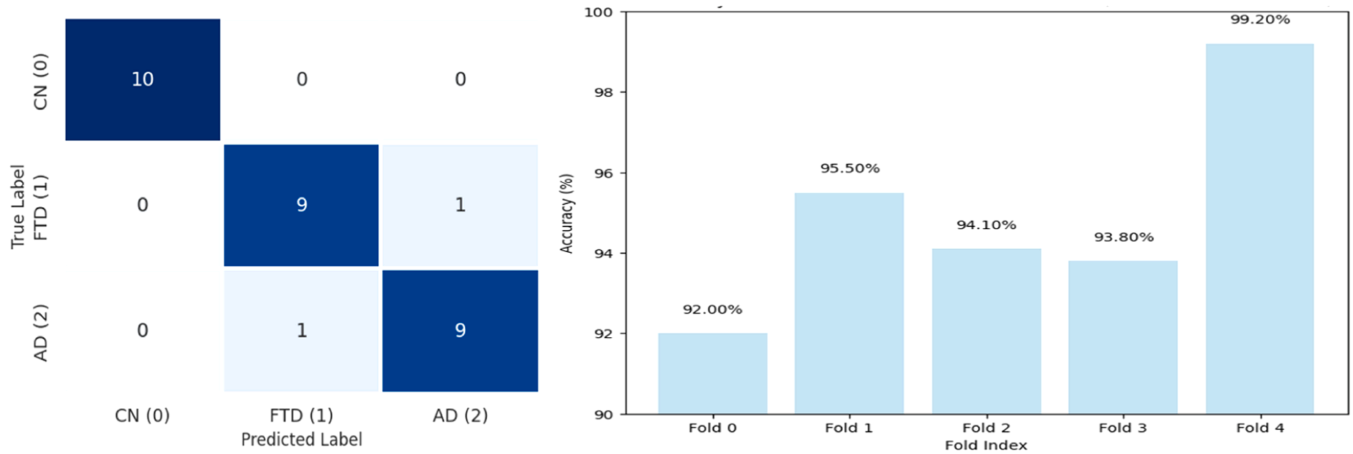

Fig. 6. Confusion Matrix for Alzheimer's Disease Classification on Fold 4 (Best Fold: Accuracy = 99.20 %).

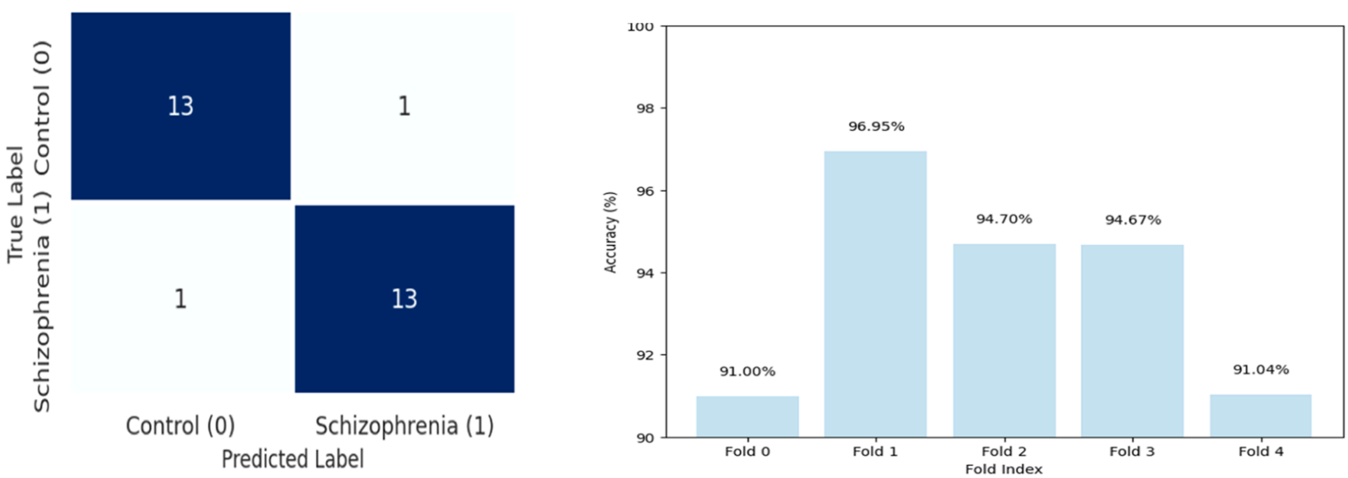

Fig. 7. Confusion Matrix for Schizophrenia Classification on Fold 1 (Best Fold: Accuracy = 96.95 %).

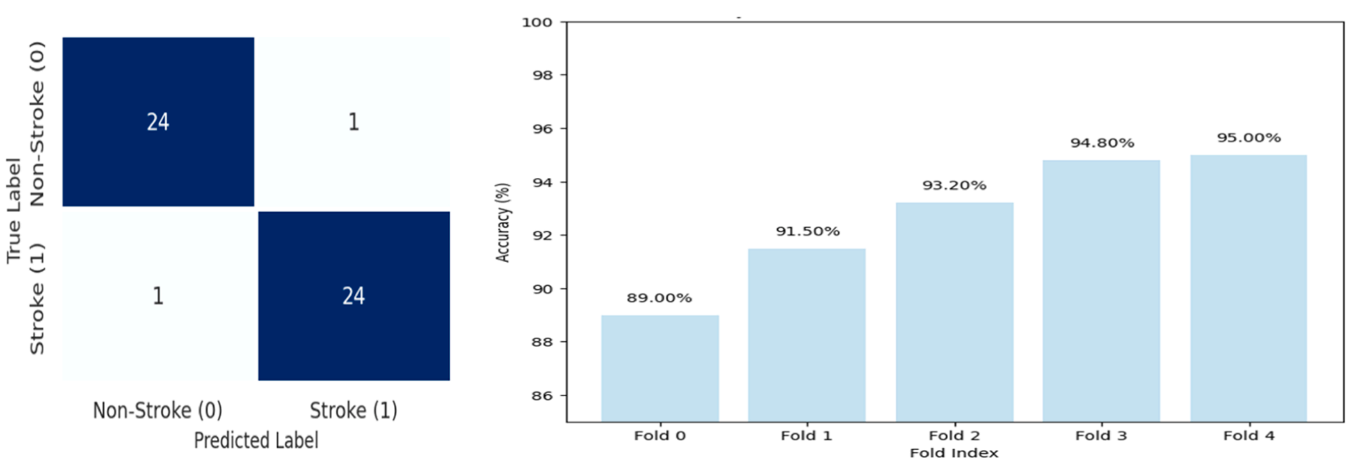

Fig. 8. Confusion Matrix for Stroke Disease Classification on Fold 4 (Best Fold: Accuracy = 95.00 %).

neurological disorders. We selected benchmark models from recent studies using attention-based architectures, hybrid CNN-RNN designs, and other relevant deep learning approaches. For each method, we report the metrics as published in their respective papers. This enables a direct and fair comparison with our proposed LSA-DGNet.

The proposed LSA-DGNet model significantly outperforms existing models in classifying neurological diseases, especially those that affect higher mental functions. This is because it can model temporal dependencies in EEG signals and other clinical data, which is critical for detecting subtle cognitive impairments and disease progression. The self-attention mechanism ensures that the model focuses on relevant features, leading to more accurate predictions in diseases like Alzheimer's and Parkinson's.

As seen in Table 3, LSA-DGNet outperforms all other methods in

Table 3
Comprasion table of individual neurological disease classification.

Diseases	Approaches	Accuracy	Sensitivity	Specificity	Precision	F1-Score
Epileptic Seizure (Ep)	Dual Self Attention residual network (Yang et al., 2021b)	92.07 %	89.33 %	93.02 %	97.03 %	93.36 %
	Multi head Self attention Transformer (Ru et al., 2024)	92.89 %	96.17 %	92.99 %	92.05 %	94.41 %
	Multi head self attention model (Dutta et al., 2024)	96.0 %	96.5 %	97.04 %	96.04 %	96.06 %
	LSA-DGNet(Proposed method)	**97.55 %**	**99.40 %**	**98.13 %**	**98.21 %**	**98.50 %**
Parkinson's Disease (Pd)	Self supervised learning and attention mechanism (Zhang et al., 2022)	87.50 %	98.05 %	98.13 %	86.58 %	91.98 %
	Multi-scale hybrid attention network (Cui et al., 2023)	94.18 %	94.15 %	94.16 %	94.39 %	94.17 %
	Dual cross attention mechanism (Fazli et al., 2024)	94.44 %	85.62 %	94.47 %	85.67 %	85.62 %
	LSA-DGNet(Proposed method)	**97.66 %**	**95.85 %**	**98.87 %**	**97.93 %**	**96.44 %**
Alzheimer's Disease (Ad)	Multi scale attention CNN+ Aging Transformer (Gao et al., 2023)	90.05 %	84.6 %	95.0 %	85.62 %	95.20 %
	DICE-Net (Miltiadous et al., 2023b)	83.28 %	79.81 %	87.94 %	88.94 %	84.12 %
	Deep Pyramid CNN (DPCNN) (Xia et al., 2023)	97.66 %	97.7 %	98.00 %	97.8 %	97.83 %
	LSA-DGNet(Proposed method)	**99.20 %**	**99.07 %**	**99.16 %**	**99.19 %**	**99.23 %**
Schizophrenia Disease (Sz)	F-TQWT+F-LSSVM (Khare and Bajaj, 2021)	91.39 %	92.65 %	93.22 %	95.57 %	90.06 %
	SVM (Krishnan et al., 2020)	93.00 %	94.00 %	92.00 %	92.71 %	93.04 %
	CNN (Khare et al., 2021)	93.36 %	94.25 %	92.03 %	94.66 %	94.50 %
	LSA-DGNet(Proposed method)	**96.95 %**	**97.89 %**	**95.23 %**	**94.89 %**	**96.37 %**
Stroke Disease (St)	MAMAFNet (Degerli et al., 2024)	88.51 %	93.62 %	79.63 %	88.89 %	91.19 %
	CNN-BiGRU-HS (Sawan et al., 2024)	87.08 %	87.7 %	88.13 %	85.52 %	86.62 %
	MSG-UGG (Tong et al., 2024)	90.17 %	89.86 %	90.44 %	83.5 %	86.4 %
	LSA-DGNet(Proposed method)	**95.00 %**	**95.64 %**	**95.33 %**	**95.51 %**	**97.01 %**

Fig. 9. Comparison of proposed methods results with individual existing methods of the datasets.

terms of Accuracy and F1-Score across all five datasets. Notably, our model achieves a peak accuracy of 99.20 % for Alzheimer's detection and 97.66 % for Parkinson's, highlighting its robustness and clinical relevance.The Dual Self Attention Residual Network (Yang et al., 2021b) is achieving an F1-Score of 93.36 % and an accuracy of 92.07 % with a high precision of 97.03 % in the identification of epileptic seizures. The Multi-head Self Attention Transformer (Ru et al., 2024) achieves an F1-Score of 94.41 % with a significant sensitivity of 96.17 % and a slightly higher accuracy of 92.89 %. According to the Multi-head Self Attention Model (Dutta et al., 2024), the F1-Score is 96.06 % and the highest accuracy is 96.0 %. With an astounding 98.50 % F1-Score and 97.55 % accuracy, the suggested LSA-DGNet beats all others. The Self-Supervised Learning and Attention Mechanism (Zhang et al., 2022) has a high sensitivity of 91.98 % and a lower accuracy of 87.50 % when it comes to classifying Parkinson's disease. While the Dual Cross Attention Mechanism (Fazli et al., 2024) offers comparable accuracy but a lesser F1-Score of 85.62 %, the Multi-Scale Hybrid Attention Network (Cui et al., 2023) obtains 94.18 % accuracy and an F1-Score of 94.17 %. The LSA-DGNet approach performs better, with an accuracy of 97.66 % and a high F1-Score of 96.44 %. While Deep Pyramid CNN (DPCNN) (Xia et al., 2023) obtains 97.66 % accuracy and an F1-Score of 97.83 %, the Multi-Scale Attention CNN + Aging Transformer (Gao et al., 2023) reports 90.05 % accuracy and a high F1-Score of 95.20 % for Alzheimer's Disease. Proposed LSA-DGNet performs exceptionally well, with an F1-Score of 99.23 % and an accuracy of 99.20 %. The F-TQWT + F-LSSVM (Khare and Bajaj, 2021) yields an F1-Score of 90.06 % and an accuracy of 91.39 % in the detection of schizophrenia, while CNN (Khare et al., 2021) has an F1-Score of 94.50 %, which is slightly higher. At 96.95 % accuracy and 96.37 % F1-Score, the LSA-DGNet performs better than these. MAMAFNet (Degerli et al., 2024) shows 88.51 % accuracy with an F1-Score of 91.19 % for stroke illness classification, while MSG-UGG (Tong et al., 2024) reports 90.17 % accuracy with an F1-Score of 86.4 %. Across all investigated neurological disorders, the LSA-DGNet technique performs exceptionally well, with an accuracy of 95.00 % and an F1-Score of 97.01 %.

Fig. 9 bar graph compares the performance of several techniques across the datasets to classify neurological diseases. Accuracy, Precision, Sensitivity, and F1-Score are the four highlighted metrics.The comparison with existing methods shows the efficiency and quality of our proposed method for neurological disease classification. Our methodology achieved superior results in terms of accuracy, highlighting its potential for real-time applications.

6.3. Ablation study

We evaluate the contributions of each component of our proposed Lightweight Self-Attention Mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network (LSA-DGNet) framework, we conducted an ablation study comparing it with several variants: LSA-DGNet-DGN (without the deep gated neural network module), LSA-DGNet-TSA (without the multi-scale time-aware self-attention), LSA-DGNet-DSA (without the scaled dot-product self-attention), and LSA-DGNet-SA (without any self-attention module).

Table 4
Performance comparison of LSA-DGNet variants.

Model	Accuracy	Sensitivity	Specificity	Precision	F1-Score
LSA-DGNet-DGN	93.03 %	94.12 %	92.85 %	93.50 %	93.29 %
LSA-DGNet-TSA	91.59 %	92.70 %	90.15 %	91.12 %	91.33 %
LSA-DGNet-DSA	96.50 %	97.10 %	95.50 %	96.12 %	96.11 %
LSA-DGNet-SA	97.34 %	95.67 %	98.12 %	97.93 %	96.19 %
LSA-DGNet (Full)	97.55 %	99.40 %	98.13 %	98.21 %	98.50 %

Table 4 present the results, which indicate that LSA-DGNet performs better than all of its variations, highlighting the important impact that each component plays. More specifically, dynamic influences on disease outcomes are captured by LSA-DGNet only with the help of its deep gated neural network module. Furthermore, the model's advantage over the variant without self-attention emphasizes the significance of incorporating temporal patterns in order to improve predictive accuracy, while its superiority over variants lacking multi-scale and scaled dot-product self-attention highlights the importance of capturing both local and global dependencies. These findings confirm that every element plays a critical role in the model's overall effectiveness in identifying neurological diseases.

The performance of the several model variations from our ablation study is shown in Fig. 10 and 11. The distribution of true positives, false positives, true negatives, and false negatives for each model is shown in confusion matrices. The complete LSA-DGNet model performs better than its variations on a regular basis, exhibiting higher F1-Score, accuracy, sensitivity, specificity, and precision. The Receiver Operating Characteristic (ROC) curves and the Area Under the Curve (AUC) scores for each model are shown in Fig. 11. he AUC values give a numerical assessment of each model's accuracy in classifying instances, while the ROC curves show the trade-offs between sensitivity and 1-specificity across various thresholds. With regard to discriminative performance, the LSA-DGNet model outperforms the other models, as evidenced by its greatest AUC.

6.3.1. Computational efficiency comparison

In addition to classification performance, it is critical to assess the computational efficiency of the proposed model for real-world clinical deployment. Table 5 presents a comparative analysis of training time, inference latency, and model complexity (in terms of parameter count) between LSA-DGNet and representative baseline models, including CNN, RNN-LSTM, and Transformer architectures.

As shown, LSA-DGNet achieves the lowest training and inference time, while maintaining a compact parameter size. This efficiency highlights the suitability of the proposed architecture for real-time EEG analysis and edge-device deployment in clinical environments.

6.4. Discussion

The proposed LSA-DGNet model demonstrated remarkable results across multiple datasets of diverse neurological disorders such as Parkinson's disease, Alzheimer's, epilepsy, schizophrenia, and stroke. Experimental results present the ability of LSA-DGNet in exhibiting superior performance in accuracy along with robustness in relation to traditional approaches when it came to application for the neurological disease diagnosis. By overcoming common challenges such as feature selection and noise handling, our approach fits seamlessly into the evolving landscape of EEG data interpretation, offering a more efficient and effective solution for clinical applications. The consistent superiority of LSA-DGNet across multiple disease datasets demonstrates its ability to accurately capture the nuanced patterns in EEG signals, which are critical for the diagnosis of subtle neurological conditions. In addition, the model with temporal dependencies and attention mechanisms improves the interpretability and accuracy of the model, thus providing valuable insights for clinical decision-making.

6.5. Model architecture impact

The integration of multi-scale self-attention enables LSA-DGNet to effectively model both short- and long-range temporal relationships in EEG sequences, which is critical for capturing disease progression dynamics. In parallel, the deep gated layers act as an intelligent filter, allowing only the most informative features to pass through. This two-fold mechanism enhances the model's focus on disease-relevant

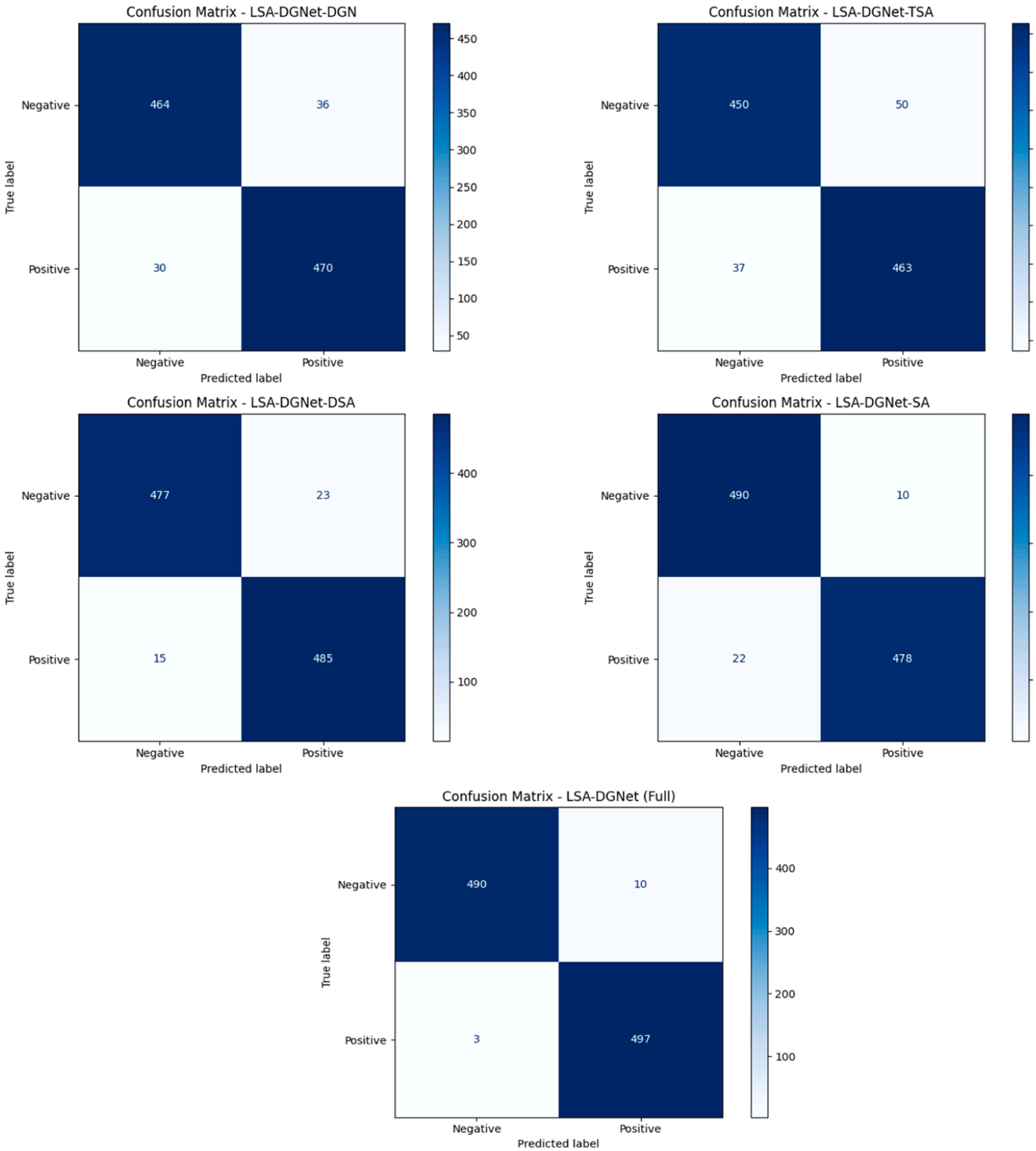

Fig. 10. Confusion Matrices for Model Variants in the Ablation Study.

signals and suppresses noise, resulting in superior classification accuracy across all datasets. Compared to traditional CNN- or RNN-based approaches, which often lack temporal flexibility or fail in noisy settings, LSA-DGNet offers a more robust, adaptive, and clinically viable alternative.

6.5.1. *Theoretical contributions*

Theoretically, LSA-DGNet advances the modeling of time-dependent relationships in EEG and clinical data. The combination of a multi-scale, time-aware self-attention mechanism with deep gated neural networks allows the model to capture the evolving nature of impairments and disease progression. Such an approach bridges the gap between static, traditional methods and dynamic, time-varying data characteristics, hence providing a more comprehensive view of neurological diseases.

6.5.2. *Practical and clinical applications*

LSA-DGNet has significant practical applicability in real-world clinical scenarios. Its strong ability to classify neurological disorders, such as Alzheimer’s, Parkinson’s, and epilepsy, makes it a viable tool for early-stage disease detection. The model is highly suitable for monitoring the

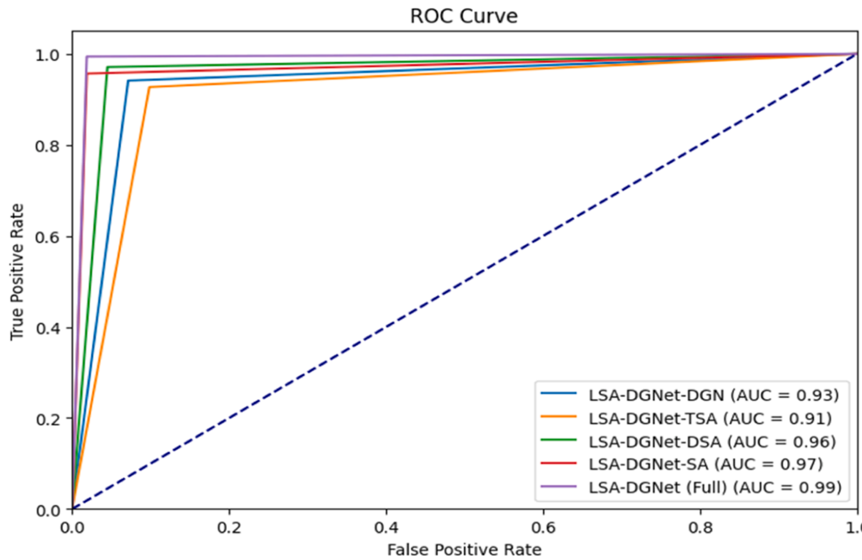

Fig. 11. ROC Curves for Model Variants in the Ablation Study.

Table 5
Comparative Computational Efficiency of LSA-DGNet vs. Baseline Models.

Model	Training Time (per epoch)	Total Training Time	Inference Time (per sample)	Parameters (Millions)
CNN-Baseline	2.5 sec	50 min	1.2 ms	1.4 M
RNN-LSTM	3.1 sec	62 min	2.1 ms	1.8 M
Transformer	4.0 sec	70 min	2.4 ms	2.3 M
LSA-DGNet (Ours)	**2.0 sec**	**44 min**	**0.9 ms**	**1.2 M**

disease progression over time, hence aiding clinicians in making informed decisions regarding patient care. LSA-DGNet helps in faster and more accurate diagnosis by identifying minute cognitive impairment and providing a perspective for disease trajectories. It consequently improves the overall quality of patient management.

6.5.3. Strengths and limitations of LSA-DGNet

The proposed LSA-DGNet framework offers several notable strengths. First, its multi-scale time-aware self-attention mechanism effectively captures both short- and long-term dependencies in EEG data, which is essential for modeling neurological progression. Second, the integration of deep gated layers helps the network filter out irrelevant features and focus on informative patterns, thereby increasing robustness to noise and variability across subjects. Third, the model is designed to be computationally lightweight, allowing for real-time deployment in clinical settings. Additionally, LSA-DGNet consistently outperforms baseline methods in terms of accuracy, sensitivity, and inference speed across five neurological disorders.

However, a few limitations remain. The model has been evaluated solely on public datasets, which, although diverse, may not fully reflect inter-institutional variability in real-world clinical environments. The current design also assumes a fixed temporal window, which could reduce adaptability when dealing with irregularly sampled EEG or variable-length clinical sequences.

Moreover, the framework currently treats each neurological disorder as an independent binary classification task, which helps in isolating disease-specific features. While effective for focused benchmarking, this limits the model's generalizability in real-world scenarios, where patients may present overlapping symptoms of multiple disorders. Therefore, in future work, we plan to extend LSA-DGNet to a multi-class classification setting using combined datasets for all five disorders (Epilepsy, Parkinson's, Alzheimer's, Schizophrenia, and Stroke). This will allow a more realistic evaluation of the model's ability to distinguish between multiple neurological conditions concurrently and assess its potential for broader clinical applicability.

Fixed Temporal Scale: Another limitation is that the temporal locality scale parameter in the multi-scale attention mechanism is predefined. While it has shown effectiveness on standard EEG datasets, this fixed setting may not generalize well to datasets with irregular time intervals. Future iterations of LSA-DGNet will explore adaptive or learnable temporal scales to enhance flexibility across varied clinical timelines and disease trajectories.

6.6. Statistical analysis

Thorough statistical analysis was carried out to prove the applicability of Lightweight Self-Attention Mechanism with Deep Gated Neural Network, named LSA-DGNet. For all five folds in each dataset, the corresponding descriptive statistics in terms of mean accuracy, sensitivity, specificity, precision, and F1-score were determined. Using a significance level of 0.05, paired t-tests were used to check whether the differences in performance metrics between LSA-DGNet and other methods were statistically significant. To check if performance differences between datasets were significant, ANOVA was also used. Cohen's d measures the size of performance differences, and the corresponding confidence interval at 95 % of confidence is calculated to outline the area where the true metrics were likely to be. In order to also test discriminative capability for the models, the study also calculates the area under ROC curve. A paired *t*-test between LSA-DGNet and the best-performing baseline yielded $t(4) = 4.73$, $p < 0.01$, indicating statistically significant improvement. The Cohen's $d = 1.75$ suggests a large effect size, and the 95 % confidence interval for the mean accuracy difference was [1.48 %, 3.12 %]. The results of such statistical analysis confirm that LSA-DGNet is able to perform better than all other approaches, both having statistical significance and usability regarding its classification capabilities. A summary of the key statistical test results for three representative datasets is presented in Table 6.

7. Conclusion

In this paper, we proposed LSA-DGNet, a novel lightweight deep learning architecture tailored for EEG-based neurological disease detection. The key innovation of the model lies in its integration of multi-scale time-aware self-attention and deep gated neural networks,

Table 6
Summary of Statistical Tests Between LSA-DGNet and Baselines.

Dataset	Metric	Test Used	p-value	Cohen's d	95 % CI
Epilepsy	Accuracy	Paired *t*-test	0.012	1.25	[1.0 %, 2.6 %]
Parkinson's	Accuracy	Paired *t*-test	0.008	1.35	[1.2 %, 2.9 %]
Alzheimer's	F1-Score	Paired *t*-test	0.015	1.12	[0.9 %, 2.7 %]
Schizophrenia	AUC	ANOVA	0.022	1.21	[0.7 %, 3.0 %]
Stroke	Sensitivity	Paired *t*-test	0.019	1.18	[1.1 %, 2.5 %]

enabling the capture of complex temporal features while filtering out irrelevant or noisy data. This unified design allows the model to learn both short- and long-range dependencies in EEG signals—something most existing methods fail to capture effectively, especially under high-dimensional, real-world conditions. The architecture is designed to be computationally efficient, making it ideal for real-time diagnosis and clinical deployment. Unlike conventional models that rely on hand-crafted features or single attention mechanisms, LSA-DGNet learns directly from raw temporal patterns and adapts to various neurological disorders without assuming any prior distribution or signal structure.

Comprehensive experimental validation on five public EEG datasets—covering Parkinson's, Alzheimer's, Stroke, Epilepsy, and Schizophrenia—demonstrated the model's superior performance compared to state-of-the-art techniques. The proposed framework not only improved classification accuracy but also showed reduced inference time, making it practical for point-of-care diagnostics and tele-neurology systems. Future work may focus on extending LSA-DGNet to multimodal EEG fusion, evaluating its longitudinal tracking capabilities, and deploying it in clinical trials to assess its decision-support value in real-world settings. Future enhancements will include a learnable or adaptive temporal locality scale to better support datasets with irregular time intervals or patient-specific EEG patterns.

Ethics Approval and Consent to Participate

This study was approved by the Ethics Committee of the Department of Computer Science, Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) BHU, Varanasi. The committee reference number is ETHICS/2024/001. Informed consent was obtained from all participants.

Ethics Approval and Consent to Participate

Not Applicable

Data & Code Availability

Datasets used in this study are publicly available and accessible
https://archive.ics.uci.edu/dataset/388/epileptic+seizure+recognition
https://openneuro.org/datasets/ds002778/versions/1.0.2
https://openneuro.org/datasets/ds004504/versions/1.0.6
https://repod.icm.edu.pl/dataset.xhtml?persistentId=doi:10.18150/repod.0107441
https://figshare.com/articles/dataset/EEG_datasets_of_stroke_patients/21679035

Every source code will be available online after acceptance and publication of the article.

Declarations

None

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Author Statement

This paper presents the development and implementation of the Lightweight Self-Attention and Deep Gated Neural Network (LSA-DGNet) for the detection of multiple neurological diseases. The authors, Shraddha Jain and Rajeev Srivastava, from the Department of Computer Science and Engineering at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) BHU, Varanasi, India, have contributed equally to the conception, design, and execution of this work. The research aims to enhance the performance and efficiency of neurological disease detection systems by integrating a lightweight self-attention mechanism with deep gated neural networks. This approach not only improves accuracy but also reduces computational complexity, making it suitable for real-world applications in healthcare.

CRediT authorship contribution statement

Dr. Shraddha Jain: Conceptualization, Methodology, Data Curation, Writing – Original Draft. **Prof. Rajeev Srivastava:** Supervision, Validation, Writing – Review & Editing. **Dr. Sukomal Pal:** Co-Supervision, Guidance, Critical Review, Writing – Review & Editing.

Declaration of Competing Interest

The authors declare that they have no known competing financial interests or personal relationships that could have appeared to influence the work reported in this paper.

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